The SAP/SI Challenge Checklist

Twelve gates for every product, licence, customisation and SI work package

Attach this page to every proposed SAP product, module, licence, customisation or SI change order. A gate closes only when the evidence in the right-hand column has been seen.

#	Gate	Question	Evidence that closes the gate	Seen
1	REQUIREMENT	What exact business problem are we solving?	Business requirement signed by the process owner, with volumes and measurable benefit.	□
2	STANDARD	What SAP standard capability was evaluated?	Fit-gap against our release and edition, with SAP documentation references.	□
3	CONFIGURATION	Why can configuration not solve it?	Configuration options tested and the reason each failed.	□
4	EXTENSION	Why can supported extensibility not solve it?	Assessment of key-user, developer and side-by-side options, with clean core level.	□
5	INTEGRATION	Why is integration required?	Data flow design, system of record per object, interface owner.	□
6	CUSTOM	Why is custom code required?	Justification, owner, clean core level, test and retirement plan.	□
7	PRODUCT	Why is another SAP product required?	Proof that owned products and standard scope cannot meet the need.	□
8	LICENCE	What exact licence is required?	Licence metric, quantity, term and the clause that grants the right.	□
9	COST	What is the five-year TCO?	Full cost model including integration, testing, support and consumption; seven-year view too.	□
10	RISK	What new dependency does this create?	Operational, technical, commercial and skills dependencies, with mitigations.	□
11	EXIT	How do we remove it later?	Exit steps, data return, notice periods and cost.	□
12	EVIDENCE	Show us the documentation.	Documents, not slides: SAP documentation, contract clauses, test results.	□

EVIDENCE REQUIRED | Who confirms which gates

- Gates 1-3: owner-side process lead (not the proposer).
- Gates 4-7 and 10: architecture / design authority.
- Gates 8, 9 and 11: finance, procurement and legal.
- Gate 12: steering committee - documents, not slides.

RED FLAG | The sentence that reopens every gate

"SAP cannot do that." Ask: which standard process, in which release, was tested - and where is the SAP documentation?